

Pain au Chocolat: A Laminated Sourdough Pastry

Bread & Pastry Flour, laminated with European-style butter, wrapped around bittersweet chocolate

DOUGH INGREDIENTS

Bread flour	350 g	70%
Pastry flour	150 g	30%
Total flour	500 g	100%
Whole milk, cold	225 g	45%
Stiff sourdough starter (45–50% hydration, ripe)	100 g	20%
Granulated sugar	50 g	10%
Fine sea salt	10 g	2%
Unsalted butter, softened (into the dough)	25 g	5%
Instant yeast (optional insurance)	4 g	0.8%
Détrempe total	914 g	

INCLUSIONS

European-style butter (82%+ fat), block	250 g	50% of détrempe flour
Combined détrempe + butter total	1,164 g	
Chocolate batons (~18, ~10 g each)	~180 g	2 per pastry

Détrempe + butter block ~1,164 g, plus chocolate batons — yields about 8–9 pastries.

TIMELINE

- **Feed levin:** Feed stiff starter 8–12 hrs before mixing, until the dome flattens and just starts to crack.
- **Mix détrempe:** Soften starter into cold milk first, then combine with everything else. Stop at smooth & cohesive, not a windowpane. Target DDT 68–72°F.
- **Rest & chill:** Flatten, wrap, and chill at least 1 hr (up to overnight).
- **Prepare butter block:** Roll cold butter into an even block, two-thirds the size of the détrempe.
- **Laminate:** Envelope-encase the butter, then 3 single folds, chilling 30–45 min between each.
- **Cut & shape:** Roll to 3–4mm, cut 4×3in rectangles, roll in two chocolate batons each, egg-wash.
- **Proof:** 1.5–3 hrs at 75–80°F until puffy with layers starting to separate at the cut edge.
- **Bake:** 400–425°F for 10 min, then 375°F for the remainder — 18–22 min total.
- **Cool:** 5 min on the tray, then a wire rack — best within a couple of hours.

Recipe card — Bruce's Breads • Bruce the Bald Baker

NOTES

◆ FOLD ALONG THIS LINE, TOP PANEL BACK — STANDS LIKE A TENT ◆